



VIA NOVA FALL NEWSLETTER

ANDREW HANNON

Dear friends and family,

I would like to share with you all a brief overview of what life in Via these last few months has looked like for me. I want to start off by extending a special thanks to all of those who have supported me with donations, prayers, and mentorship. Without you, it would not be possible for me to participate in this time of study, work, and prayer. I am very grateful for your support.



Seminar with Father Guillory on the *Odyssey*.

Moving out of my parents' home into community life was a pretty big change. Via has been the perfect transition experience for me, allowing me to exercise more independence away from my parents' home while still enjoying the companionship of other Catholic men with the same goals and values.

Three days out of the week, we have sequences of seminars led by "tutors" in the community. Teachers at the university of oxford are referred to as tutors because of the oxford model of teaching. The oxford model focuses on learning through reading and presentation rather than your typical lectures. In Via, we implement the oxford method within our studies, which is why we refer to our teachers as tutors. Our first sequence was led by Father John Joseph Bourque, CJC on the culture and writings of ancient Israel, focusing on the Old Testament. Fr. John Joseph really helped me go deeper into the Old Testament by reading it more thoroughly, which allowed us to take more time to comprehend the text. This helped me learn valuable lessons from the Scriptures on how to live a holy life and the dangers of being attached to worldly goods. Following his sequence, Deacon Conque led us in learning about the prophets. We saw that most of the prophets came from the lowly and were raised up to high positions to do significant things for God. As we looked deeper into their stories, we saw how much God uses the lowly and humble for His greater glory. Now, we are in the middle of the ancient Greece sequence, and presently focusing on Homer's *Odyssey* led by Father Joshua Guillory. With his help, we have been able to break down the text more thoroughly and learn life lessons from the ancient Greeks. One example of a lesson learned from the ancients is the importance of being hospitable to all people, especially the poor. In the *Odyssey*, we see

numerous ancient pagans practicing hospitality to the poor, which connects to our Catholic faith as illustrated in Matthew's Gospel. Matt 25:40, "And the king will answer them, 'Truly, I say to you, as you did it to one of the least of these my brothers, you did it to me.'"

Each morning, all of the fellows and myself go to the chapel to spend about an hour in silence with Our Lord. With the help of my brothers, we can keep each other accountable by making sure we are in the chapel on time every morning. We also depend on accountability for each other in our community life with frequent check-ins to discuss different virtues we are growing in, etc. At night, we have communal night prayer, or compline, to end our days. Along with compline comes an examination of conscience, which is a perfect way to end your day. This is another great way that we are able to ensure we keep that aspect of daily prayer in our lives.

A pool deck Isaac and I helped build with Brice Cambre and Sam Pitre.



Peak of the Blue Lakes Trail leading up to Mt. Sneffels. Pictured are Sam Leblanc, Isaac Lejeune, Andrew Hannon, Anthony Salvatierra, Rachel Friddell, and Ann-Ayrisse Salvatierra.

In the beginning of September, I started working for Saint Joseph's Handyman with Mr. Sam Pitre. This was not the job I planned to have started with, but I have learned a lot of great things. Mr. Sam is a devout Catholic, and as a boss, he makes sure that we keep prayer structured into our work. We start the job off by praying the Litany of Humility to keep us humble in our work and end with a Glory Be. Although I do like my job, and I am so grateful to be in a work environment in which prayer is an integral component, I don't believe this is the career I am called to and I am in the process of interviewing with another company.



ST. JOSEPH'S
HANDYMAN

Over the last three months, we've had many exciting and formative experiences, including trips, talks, seminars, and more. Our first public event hosted by Via was a talk by Mrs. Kim Boudreaux, the CEO of Catholic Charities, and over 30 people attended. A few days before the talk, we realized our house had no insulation in the wall so we decided to do it ourselves to save money and learn a new life skill. With the help of a friend in the community named Michael, we insulated our house. We started at 9:00 am, took a break for most of the afternoon and finished around 12:30 am the night before the talk. I was very moved by Mrs. Kim's story and how she was able to surrender her life to God's will by selling everything she owned. For our first event I'd say it was a success and touched the hearts of many.



Isaac and I insulating our house before Mrs. Kim's talk.



Enjoying a hot meal prepared by Ann-Ayrissse after a day of hiking.

Towards the end of September, we took a trip to Colorado for hiking, prayer and reflection. On the way up to Colorado, we stayed overnight at Clear Creek Abbey, a Benedictine monastery in Hulbert, Oklahoma. I really enjoyed seeing how simple their lives were, but yet how happy they all seemed to be. We spent four days in Colorado, and each day came with its own exciting and formative adventure. Most notably, on our last day there, we had the opportunity to climb a 14,155 foot mountain, named Mount Sneffels. The hike through the woods to get to the mountain was so beautiful and the weather was perfect. Although I didn't summit, the hike and climb is still a memory not to be forgotten and a once in a lifetime experience that I am very thankful for.

I'll share a little story about a song Anthony and I wrote about Waffle House on our way to Colorado. We wrote and sang it hoping it would convince Luke, the head of Via, to let us go. We later found out that there was no Waffle House in Colorado so we'd have to wait until we made it back home. About a week after returning home Luke was meeting with a benefactor, Mr. Taylor, and was showing him pictures and videos from our trip. Mr. Taylor came across a video of us singing our song and told Luke he wanted to pay for us to go to Waffle House. The following week we met Mr. Taylor at Waffle House and before we sat down to eat he made us sing in front of the whole restaurant. We were not expecting this but because of our crave for the chocky (chocolate milk), we overcame our fear and sang our best. In the end, it was all worth it.

In the middle of October, my brothers in Via and I took a trip to Oklahoma for the Three Hearts Pilgrimage. We camped overnight in hot springs, Arkansas where we cooked steaks over the fire and sang a few songs. The morning after, we went on a beautiful two mile hike next to the campground. Once we arrived in Hulbert, OK, we began our pilgrimage, which consisted of a thirty five-mile walk over the course of two days. There were over 2,000 people in attendance, and it was really great being surrounded by so many devout Catholics. It was amazing to see all the different people making the walk, from grandparents to little kids, and it was very inspiring to see their strong will for sacrifice by walking barefoot, carrying children, etc. Even the fellows and I carried kids on our backs for some time. The pilgrimage was a great experience, and I am very glad that I was able to make it. I made a few new friends while I was there and grew much closer with my brothers in Via.



In front of Our Lady of Clear Creek Abbey, the final destination of the Three Hearts Pilgrimage. Pictured from left to right are Anthony, Luke Manuel (not a Fellow), Sam, Isaac, myself, and Peter.



The Three Hearts Pilgrimage processing into Our Lady of Clear Creek Abbey.

We've had quite a few events at our house over the past three months. Our latest event with Via was a series of three talks on finance. We discussed the importance of maintaining a balance between financial and spiritual life, and ensuring that one isn't attached to his money or worldly goods. As Catholics, we need to be aware of the temptations money and wealth can present to us. That's why it's great that we are able to have these conversations as young adults with men and women who have already gone through these experiences.



Processing in the Fete De Dieu Teche, a Eucharistic procession by foot and by boat on the Bayou Teche.



Traditional Lebanese dinner hosted by Father Cambre in his rectory at Saint Peter's Church in Carencro.



A look at Mount Sneffels through binoculars.

MY PRAYER INTENTIONS

- To grow closer to Christ and that I may better acknowledge his presence in my everyday life.
- Virtue of patience in community life.
- For my discernment in career options.

Once more, thank you for all of your support and please keep us in your prayers. I've listed my prayer intentions above, and you can reach out to me if you have any prayer intentions for yourself. It would be a privilege to pray for you.

**God bless,
Andrew**

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Making Taiwanese dumplings at Braxton and Libby Callens' house, with Every & All Missionaries.



On the Feast of the Nativity of Mary, we had a few friends over to make sushi and celebrate.